UNIT 2 Media

Text 2 Review +Text 1

Lesson 2 / 4

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Roadmap



01

Review of Text 2



Text 2

1 “Social media” is one of those terms that means different things to different people. Some history: It was originally associated with Web 2.0, the Web’s shift from publishing to a platform for the masses to share content and opinions. Then the corporate world caught on that social media wasn’t just for consumers; the term Enterprise 2.0 emerged to take Web 2.0 inside the enterprise, and the phrase social media

"社交媒体"这个词对不同的人有不同的理解。回顾一下历史：这个概念最初与 Web 2.0 联系在一起，当时网络正从单向的信息发布平台转型为让普通大众分享内容和表达观点的平台。后来，企业界发现社交媒体不只是给普通消费者用的；于是"企业 2.0"的概念应运而生，把 Web 2.0 的理念带入了企业内部应用，"社交媒体"的含义也随之扩展，涵盖了消费者端和企业端两个方面。

Text 2



2 Now with the huge and growing popularity and influence of Facebook, Twitter and, more recently, Google+, **common use of social media is swinging back to the Web**, but with a more limited scope—synonymous with consumer-side social networking.

如今，随着 Facebook、Twitter 以及最近的 Google+ 的广泛且不断增长的普及度和影响力，社交媒体的常见用途正在回归到网络平台，但范围更加有限——**等同于消费者端的社交网络**。

Text 2

3 For some clarity, let's look at the three ways the phrase social media is used today:

(1) As an umbrella term that covers all uses of the new social technologies—aka social collaboration, community collaboration, and social computing. It connotes an online environment established for the purpose of **mass collaboration**. But it must have a purpose—e.g., Facebook is an online environment for the purpose of interacting with a large number of friends.

作为**统称/umbrella term（概括性术语）**，涵盖所有新型社交技术的应用——包括社交协作、社区协作和社交计算。这个含义指的是为实现**大规模协作**而建立的在线环境。但这种环境必须有明确的目的——比如，Facebook 就是一个专门用于与大量好友互动的在线环境。

Text 2

3 …

(2) As a term for environments on the Web—aka social Web, collaborative Web, ReadWrite Web and Web 2.0—referring to social sites open to the general public. This usage gets most of the press, with the 700 million or so users on Facebook, massive Twitter traffic and the huge Web **blogosphere**. It's becoming standard for large organizations to maintain a marketing communications presence on the major social sites on the Web.

（2）指**网络上的社交环境**——也叫做社交网络、协作网络、读写网络和 Web 2.0——特指那些面向普通大众开放的社交网站。这是**最受媒体关注**的用法，比如 Facebook 拥有约 7 亿用户、Twitter 流量巨大、以及庞大的**网络博客圈**。如今，大型企业在主流社交网站上建立营销传播形象已经成为**标准配置**。

Text 2

4 How to achieve real business value from social media? One of the first steps on this path is understanding how to tap into the power of what we call mass collaboration. We believe that achieving this distinctive kind of collaboration is the true so-what of social media. Success involves adhering to six core principles:

- **Participation.** Mobilize the masses to contribute. The value comes not from the technology itself but from user participation and the user-generated content this facilitates.
- **Collective.** People must **swarm** to the effort. This act of going to the content to contribute is a fundamental shift in behavior that enables the scale of mass collaboration.

Text 2



4 …

- **Transparency.** Allow the community to validate and organize content. Through this transparency, the community improves content, unifies information, self-governs, self-corrects, evolves, creates emergence, and propels its own advancement.
- **Independence.** Participants can contribute independent of any other—no matter where they are or whoever else may be posting content at that time; **no coordination of collaboration** or pre-existing relationship is required.
- **Persistence.** Contributions must endure for scaled value, captured in a persistent state for others to view, share, and augment.

Text 2

4 …

- **Emergence.** Communities self-direct for greater **productivity**. Emergence is what allows these communities to come up with new ways of working or new solutions to seemingly **intractable** problems.

Intractable (adj.) 难驾驭的,顽固的,倔强的

- Intractable materials 不易加工的材料
- Intractable pain 难消除的疼痛
- Intractable problems 难题

- **涌现原则（Emergence）**

Text 2

5 These are the pillars of collaborative success. **The technology itself is not what matters; no social technology is great enough to save efforts that ignore the fundamental principles of mass collaboration.**

这些就是**协作成功的支柱**。真正重要的不是技术本身；如果违背了大规模协作的基本原则，再先进的社交技术也救不了你。

02

Text 1

How TikTok broke social media?



Background: TikTok

https://www.economist.com/business/2023/03/21/how-tiktok-broke-social-media

TikTok, known in mainland China and Hong Kong as Douyin, is a social media and short-form online video platform owned by Chinese Internet company ByteDance. It hosts user-submitted videos, which may range in duration from three seconds to 60 minutes. It can be accessed through a mobile app or through its website.

Find the paragraphs of each section.



What do you see from the two charts on Page 35?

X-axis
横轴

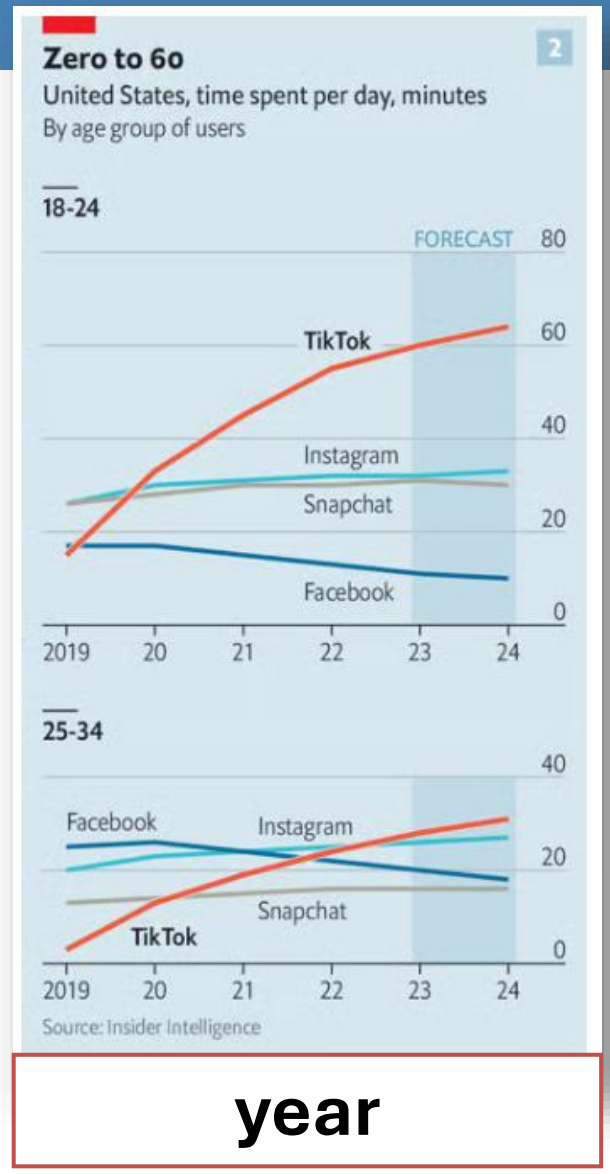
Y-axis
纵轴

Lines
折线



Users (monthly Active)

year



Time spent Per day

year

Paragraph 1: Game time!

- ✓ Find out meanings of all the ***VERBS***.
- ✓ Now. Paragraph 1.
- ✓ Start!



Text (Para. 1)

TikTok's fate **hangs in the balance**. But what is already clear is that the app has changed social media for good—and in a way that will make life harder for **incumbent** social apps. In less than six years, TikTok has **weaned** the world **off** the old-fashioned social **networking** and got it **hooked on** algorithmically selected short videos. Users love it. The trouble for the platforms is that the new model makes less money than the old one, and may always do so.

Translation

TikTok的命运**悬而未决**。
但已经显而易见的是，这款应用彻底改变了社交媒体，并且这种改变将使**现有（老牌）**社交应用的日子更加艰难。
在不到六年的时间里，TikTok让世界**摆脱**了传统**社交网络**，转而**迷上了**由算法筛选的短视频。
用户喜爱这种模式。然而，对于这些平台来说，麻烦在于新模式的盈利能力不如旧模式，而且这种差距可能永远存在。

Words and phrases

Hang (v.) 悬挂；悬而未决

- To remain in a suspended, contingent, or uncertain state
- 用于表达不确定性或风险，如：“The merger deal **hangs** in the balance.”（并购交易悬而未决。）

Wean off (v.) 戒掉，使脱离

- To cause someone or something to detach from a dependence on an old habit or product.
- 用于描述消费者习惯或系统迁移：“It is difficult to **wean** established users off the legacy platform.”（很难让老用户摆脱对遗留平台的依赖。）

Words and phrases

Hook on 使…上瘾；迷上

- To become highly captivated by or dependent on a product or service.
- **用户粘性**。描述产品如何成功地吸引用户，使其持续使用并形成习惯。
- e.g. Our goal is to redesign the platform to **get** users **hooked on** the personalized content feed immediately.

Incumbent (adj.) 现存的；在位的；占据原有市场的

- An established company, system, or technology currently dominating a market.
- **老牌企业**。特指在市场中占据主导地位，通常面临来自新兴竞争对手颠覆性挑战的公司。
- The startup’s low-cost subscription model is designed to disrupt the pricing power of the **incumbent** industry leaders.

Paragraph 2: Game time!

- ✓ Find out how **FIGURES (数字)** are described in Para 2.
- ✓ For example, “more than”, “twice as”....
- ✓ Now. Start!



Descriptions of figures in Paragraph 2

all but a handful of

- **几乎所有（除了极少数）**：表示该数字在同类群体中处于极高地位，仅次于少数例外。

more than twice as long

- **两倍多长**：用于比较时间或持续长度，强调差异显著（大于 200%）。

twice as long as

- **两倍于...时长**：精确的倍数比较，强调差异是 2:1。

more than five times as long as

- **五倍多于...时长**：显著的倍数差异，强调差距巨大（大于 5:1）。

量化和比较 Quantification and comparison

绝对比较 (Absolute Superiority/Exclusion)

- 强调主体在群体中的优势地位

倍数差异 (Multiples)

- 强调差异的幅度

Text (Para.2)

The speed of the change is **astonishing**. Since entering America in 2017, TikTok has picked up more users than all but a **handful** of social media apps, which have been around more than twice as long (see Chart 1 on the next page). Among young audiences, it **crushes** the competition.

Key Expressions

变革的速度**令人震惊**。
自 2017 年进入美国市场以来，TikTok 所获得的用户数量，已经超越了**几乎所有**其他社交媒体应用——而那些应用出现的时间是 TikTok 的两倍多。
在年轻受众群体中，它更是**碾压**了竞争对手。

Text （Para. 2）

Americans aged 18–24 spend an hour a day on TikTok, twice as long as they spend on Instagram and Snapchat, and more than five times as long as they spend on Facebook, which these days is mainly a **medium** for communicating with the grandparents (see Chart 2 on the next page).

Translation

18 至 24 岁的美国人平均每天在 TikTok 上花费一小时，这是他们在 Instagram 和 Snapchat 上花费时长的两倍，更是他们在 Facebook 上花费时长的五倍多；如今，Facebook 主要已沦为与祖父母辈进行交流的**媒介**（参见下一页图表 2）。”

Paragraph 3 & 4: Writing techniques

- ✓ Find out the **MAIN STRUCTURE** of long sentences in Paragraph 3 and 4.
- ✓ What **writing techniques** have been used to expand the sentences?
- ✓ **Now. Start!**



Para 3: Main structure of long sentences

插入语 Appositives
同位语 Parentheticals (名词短语)

Meta has turned...and launched...

- **1. 插入语/定语从句：**which owns Facebook and Instagram (修饰 Meta)。
- **2. 并列谓语：**has turned (改变了主页) **and** launched (推出了 Reels)。
- **3. 补充说明（同位语/后置定语）：**a TikTok clone bolted onto Facebook and Instagram (进一步解释 Reels 的性质)。

状语从句 Adverbial Clauses
定语从句 Adjective Clauses

Douyin is having a similar effect...

- **1. 插入语：**TikTok's Chinese sister app, Douyin (使用同位语对主语进行命名和解释)。
- **2. 状语从句/地点定语从句：**where digital giants like Tencent7 are increasingly putting short videos at the center of their offerings (解释产生影响的具体背景和环境)。

Para 4: Main structure of long sentences

40 minutes are spent watching video clips

分词短语 participle phrase

- **1. 介词短语引导的限定：**Of the 64 minutes that... (限定了分析数据的总量范围)。
- **2. 定语从句：**that the average American spends viewing such services each day (修饰 64 分钟的性质)。
- **3. 分词短语（补充信息）：**up from 28 minutes just three years ago (提供了时间上的增长比较)。
- **4. 句末插入语/独立结构：**estimates Bernstein, a broker (提供了数据来源和其身份)。

the format is proving less profitable...

- **1. 让步状语从句：**Although users have a seemingly endless appetite for short video (提出了一个有利的事实，与主句形成对比)。
- **2. 比较级结构：**less profitable than the old news feed (进行直接的盈利能力比较)。

Text (Para. 3)

TikTok's success has **prompted** its rivals to reinvent themselves.

Meta, which owns Facebook and Instagram, has turned both apps' main **feeds** into algorithmically sorted "discovery engines" and launched Reels, a TikTok clone **bolted** onto Facebook and Instagram.

TikTok's Chinese sister app, Douyin, is having a similar effect in its home market, where **digital giants** like Tencent are increasingly putting short videos at the center of their offerings.

Translation

TikTok 的成功**促使**它的竞争对手们彻底重塑自我。

拥有 Facebook 和 Instagram 的 Meta 公司，已经将这两款应用的主页**信息流**转变为由算法分类的“发现引擎”，并推出了 Reels，这是一个快速**附加到** Facebook 和 Instagram 上的 TikTok 克隆产品。

TikTok 的中国姐妹应用“抖音”，在本土市场也正产生着类似的影响，在中国，像腾讯这样的**数字巨头**们正越来越多地将短视频置于其产品服务的核心位置。

Text (Para. 4)

The result is that short-form video has **taken over** social media.

Of the 64 minutes that the average American spends viewing such services each day, 40 minutes are spent watching video clips, up from 28 minutes just three years ago, estimates Bernstein, a **broker**.

However, this transformation comes with a **snag**.

Although users have a seemingly endless appetite for short video, the format is proving less **profitable** than the old news feed.

Translation

结果就是，短视频已经**占据**了社交媒体的主导地位。

据**券商**伯恩斯坦 (Bernstein) 估计，美国人平均每天花费 64 分钟观看此类服务，其中有 40 分钟用于观看视频剪辑，而就在三年前，这一时长仅为 28 分钟。

然而，这场变革也伴随着一个**障碍**。

尽管用户对短视频的需求似乎无穷无尽，但事实证明，这种格式的**盈利能力**不如旧式的新闻信息流。

Words and phrases

Prompt (v.) 促使；推动

- **prompt** a review/a crisis/a decision/rivals to act

Reinvent (v.) 重塑、革新

- **reinvent** the business model/oneself/the product



Feeds (n.) 信息流，推送内容

- news **feed** / social **feeds**



Bolt (v.) 快速连接、集成

- **bolt** onto a platform/a structure/an existing system

Offering 产品；服务

- product **offering** / service **offering** / core **offering**

Words and phrases

take over 接管；收购

- Take over the job 接管工作
- take over the factories 接管工厂

Broker 经纪人、中介人、金融机构

- **Securities Broker** (证券经纪人)
- **To broker a deal/agreement** (撮合交易/协议)

snag (n.) 障碍、难题

- **Hit a snag** (遇到障碍)
- **To smooth out snags** (解决难题/消除障碍)

profitable (adj.) 可盈利的，有利润的

- **Sustainably Profitable** (可持续盈利的)
- **To make something profitable** (使某事盈利)

Homework

- Complete Page 39 <Exploring the Text> Task 1 and 2.
- Complete Page 47 < Language skills> Task 1.

END